



MAKEUP ARTIST

JOB DESCRIPTION

Makeup artists work in the film, TV, theater, music, and fashion industries. They apply makeup and style hair for models or performers, whether they are trying to create a dynamic look for a model, a natural look for a TV host, or a dramatic image for a rock musician. In television or theater, they may work with production and costume designers to design prosthetics, create a desired style, or capture a historical period.



SALARY

Makeup artist ★★★★★

Makeup stylist ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Many opportunities for freelance work • Employers generally based in large cities • High-profile makeup artists can charge high fees

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **FASHION DESIGNER** *see pp. 30–31*
- ▶ **COSMETOLOGIST** *see pp. 302–303*
- ▶ **COSTUME DESIGNER** Designs clothes and accessories that actors wear in their performances. Costume designers combine their own creative instincts with extensive research into the clothes and styles associated with a particular era or location. They must ensure that costumes are authentic, as well as comfortable for the performers to wear.
- ▶ **HAIRDRESSER** Cuts, colors, or shapes a client's hair to create the style they want. Training can either be on the job or at a technical school.
- ▶ **WIGMAKER** Creates wigs for a film, TV, or theatrical production. Wigmakers may work with a costume designer or director to decide on a specific look. They also design and create wigs and hairpieces for patients with medical conditions.

AT A GLANCE



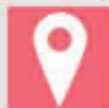
YOUR INTERESTS Makeup and hair • Fashion • Art • Photography and videography • Design • Drama • History • Film and theater studies



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Certification in makeup or hairdressing followed by work experience at a beauty salon is the most common entry route.



LIFESTYLE This is a demanding job with no regular schedule. Working hours are long and can stretch into the night if working on a film or video shoot.



LOCATION A makeup artist works mainly in theaters, film and TV studios, or in the offices of commercial video companies. Overseas travel is possible.



THE REALITIES Competition for work is tough, and success depends on experience and the ability to build a network of contacts in the industry.